them together could create a movement to impose sanctions on Israel.

An Israeli attack could mark the end of the era of global nuclear proliferation.

This entire description of the “day after” would apply only to an Israeli attack that achieved results that were less than the destruction of the entire Iranian nuclear infrastructure and/or the collapse of the regime. An attack that brought about the collapse of the regime would win Israel much praise. This is based on the precedent of the Israeli attack on the Iraqi nuclear reactor (Operation Tamuz), which was a successful “closed case” that did not provoke any extreme reactions against Israel.

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In June 2015, on the eve of the signing of the nuclear agreement between Iran, the United States, and its allies, the first question I asked myself was “Will there be an agreement?” And the answer I gave myself was “Apparently so!” And the main reason was that President Obama saw the agreement as a seminal achievement for his legacy as president. The Iranians, who understood this, would use all of their negotiating talents to extract more and more concessions. On what basis did I determine this? On the basis of the fifty years I had been working on Iran, two and a half of which I spent living and working in that country. My greatest teacher of the Persian language was the Tehran bazaar. As noted earlier, the bazaar is not just a shopping center but the center of the Persian art of negotiation. And regarding that art, there is no contest between Western culture and Persian culture.

Following the Iran-Iraq War, which continued throughout the 1980s, and after the Cold War and the First Gulf War, revolutionary Iran consolidated its national security doctrine and defined its future strategy. The Iranians reached the conclusion that Iran needed comprehensive strategic capabilities (chemical, biological, nuclear, and means of delivery), first, to ensure Iran’s immunity from external aggressions, including American threats, and second, to enable Iran to realize its imperial foreign policy goals and become a regional power. As far as Iran is concerned, military nuclear capability is a necessary condition for the realization of these two objectives.